Life sciences: nutrients and digestion

Middle school - Year 4 (4AM) | Original concept sheet, questions and answers

1. Food and nutrients

Food provides matter and energy. Nutrient groups include carbohydrates, lipids, proteins, vitamins, mineral salts and water. A balanced diet varies with age, activity and individual needs.

2. Digestion

Digestion transforms food into small nutrients that can pass through the intestinal wall. The digestive tract includes mouth, oesophagus, stomach, small intestine and large intestine.

3. Absorption and cells

Most nutrient absorption occurs in the small intestine. Nutrients enter the blood (some lipids also enter lymph) and travel to organs and cells. Cells use nutrients for energy, growth and repair.

4. Questions

1) Name three nutrient groups. 2) Where does most absorption occur? 3) Explain digestion vs absorption. 4) Why is water important? 5) Put in order: small intestine, mouth, stomach, oesophagus.

5. Answer key

1) Any three nutrient groups. 2) Small intestine. 3) Digestion transforms food; absorption moves nutrients into internal transport. 4) Water supports transport, temperature control and chemical reactions. 5) Mouth -> oesophagus -> stomach -> small intestine.

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